# OpenClaw Introduction

## Course Overview

This course will introduce you to the fundamental concepts of OpenClaw, helping you quickly understand what OpenClaw is, its core features, and its unique advantages. After completing this course, you will have a preliminary understanding of OpenClaw, laying the foundation for further learning.

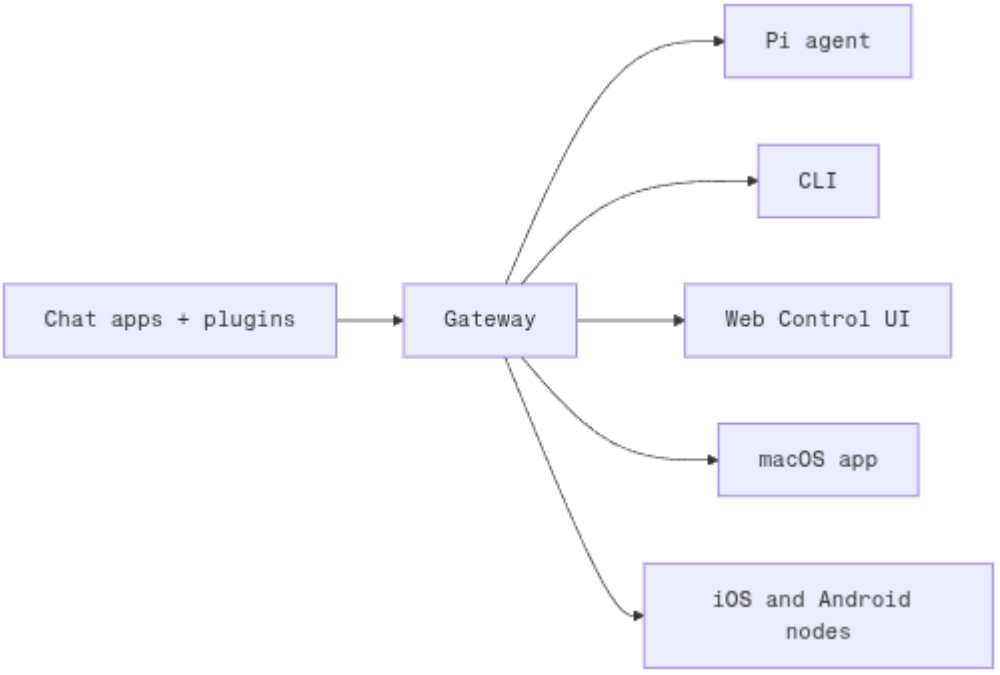
## Course Content

- Understand the definition and core value of OpenClaw
- Master the key features and characteristics of OpenClaw

## 1. What is OpenClaw

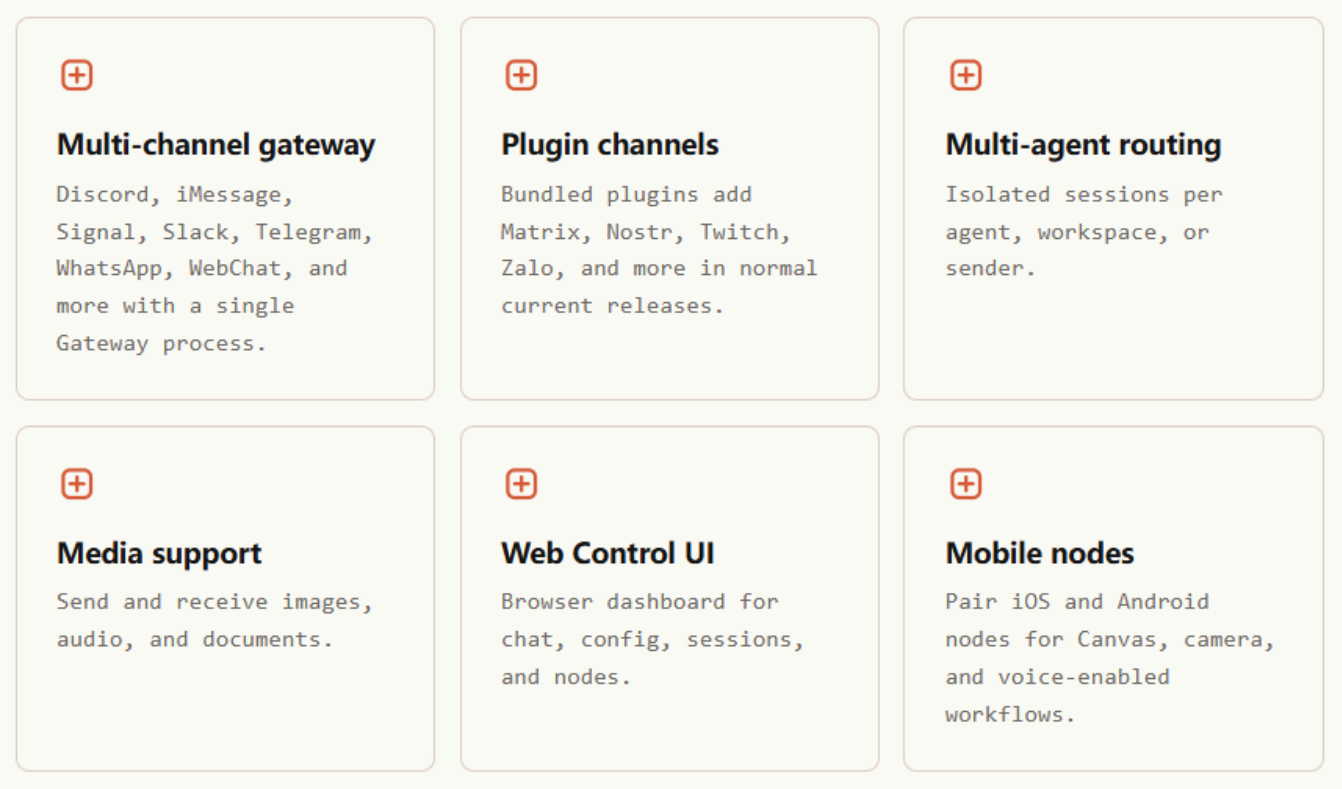



OpenClaw is a self-hosted AI Agent Gateway that connects your favorite chat applications (such as Discord, Google Chat, iMessage, Matrix, Microsoft Teams, Signal, Slack, Telegram, WhatsApp, Zalo, etc.) to AI coding agents. You simply run a Gateway process on your own machine, and it becomes a bridge between your messaging apps and an always-online AI assistant.



## 2. Core Features

- **Multi-channel Support**: A single Gateway can connect to multiple chat channels simultaneously
- **Session Management**: Creates independent sessions for each sender, maintaining context continuity
- **Agent-Native**: Designed specifically for coding agents, supporting tool usage, conversations, memory, and multi-agent routing
- **Self-Hosted**: Runs on local hardware, with full data control under your command




## 3. Unique Advantages

| Feature | Description |
|---|---|
| Self-Hosted | Runs on your hardware, works by your rules |
| Multi-Channel | One gateway serves multiple chat channels simultaneously |
| Agent-Native | Designed specifically for AI coding agents |

## 4. Summary

OpenClaw provides developers and advanced users with a convenient, secure, and controllable way to use AI assistants. By connecting various chat channels, it enables communication with AI agents anytime, anywhere, while maintaining complete control over data.